head at the Emperor Akbar's court; the Rana however refused to hear the sounds of the kalamam (kalima), he only heard the sounds of the veda-purana. The heroic warrior refused to worship at a mosque, he only worshipped at a temple.' These lines demonstrate the poet's robust knowledge of the way in which Mewar patrons viewed themselves. However, he also wrote poems in praise of Man Singh, and of Akbar himself.

After Rana Pratap died in 1597 his son, Amar Singh, would survive as a guerrilla chieftain in the hills before finally surrendering to Khurram, Jahangir's son, in 1615. He would be treated with great courtesy by Jahangir and never made to attend the Mughal court or offer a daughter in marriage. Both his son, Karan Singh, and grandson, Jagat Singh, would attend the Mughal court and would consequently lose precedence amongst the ranas of Mewar for doing so.

As the decades and the centuries passed, this one battle, this lone Rajput, came to symbolize a great deal of collective nostalgia and yearning, reflecting a shifting attitude to Mughal rule. In an early chronicle, Amrit Rai's *Mancarit*, written to eulogize Man Singh's great achievement, the poet writes that 'the Rana was defeated in battle, having put his foot on the shoulder of death'. He celebrates Man Singh's exemplary military service, when he took up the paan offered by Akbar, thereby stepping up to the challenge of fighting for the Padshah.

> All became the dependents of our master emperor Akbar Those who did not touch his feet passed their days in fear.

Amrit Rai does not mention the inconvenient matter of the rana not being captured by Man Singh, nor the fact that the Kachhwaha chieftain did not allow the plundering of the rana's lands, these subtleties of conflicting loyalties and pragmatic solutions escaping the poet's recording. But later narratives were not so understanding of Mughal–Rajput alliances. More than 200 years later, at the dawn of a new century, and in the service of a new empire, a young Scotsman and soldier in the East India Company (EIC) grew enamoured with the stories of Rajput martial valour. Bringing with him his own notions of European chivalry and feudalism, of knights fighting the Ottoman Turks, James Tod constructed a history that focused largely on Mewar, and only on the Rajputs, to the exclusion of all other Rajasthani peoples. In highly charged language he spoke of Mewar's